

# Mould & Condensation Guide

## What is condensation?

Condensation is water that forms on cold surfaces when moist air comes into contact with them. It's most noticeable on windows and tiles, but it can form on any surface and may only be visible once mould begins to grow.

## Why does it matter?

Condensation makes a property less pleasant to live in and can cause damp, mould and long-term damage. Preventing excess moisture is the key to avoiding problems.

## How to Reduce Moisture

### 1. When Cooking

- Always turn on the kitchen extractor fan.
- Keep lids on pans where possible.
- Keep the kitchen door closed to stop steam spreading to other rooms.
- After cooking, leave the fan running for at least 10 minutes.

HMO note: The use of portable gas heaters or electric heaters is not permitted under any circumstances.

### 2. When Showering

- Turn on the bathroom extractor fan (mandatory in HMOs).
- If your bathroom has a window, open it for 5-10 minutes after showering.
- If your bathroom has no window, you must leave the door open after your shower so the steam can escape.
- Always keep the bathroom door closed while showering to stop moisture spreading into the house.

### 3. Drying Clothes

- Avoid drying clothes in bedrooms.
- If you must use an airer, keep the window slightly open and close your bedroom door.
- Never dry clothes directly on radiators – it creates a large amount of moisture very quickly.

### 4. Ventilate Your Bedroom Daily

- Open your bedroom window for at least 5 minutes every day, once you're dressed and ready to leave.
- You won't be cold, and it helps you feel the real temperature outside for choosing clothes for the day.
- Use the trickle vent or "lock but slightly open" setting on your window to allow a small airflow throughout the day.
- Don't push your bed or furniture tight against cold external walls – leave a 9-inch gap so air can circulate.

### 5. General Ventilation Tips

- Don't block air bricks or vents.
- Keep wardrobes slightly away from cold external walls to prevent moisture building behind them.
- If windows steam up, wipe them and the sills dry each morning.

### 6. Heating the Home

- The heating is set to maintain a healthy indoor temperature.
- The system heats the property only when the temperature drops below the set level.
- For example, if the house is already at 20°C, radiators may feel warm but not hot – this is normal.
- If the temperature drops below 17°C, the heating will automatically activate again.
- Overnight the heating rests, then warms up again before most people wake up.
- The system also brings the house to around 19-20°C in the evenings.

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# Is mould or condensation appearing in your bedroom or property?



HG Mould Spray is a cleaning product specifically designed to remove mould and mildew from surfaces. Here's a step-by-step guide on how to use it effectively:

## What You'll Need:

- HG Mould Spray
- Cleaning gloves (optional, but recommended)
- New soft cloth or sponge
- Ventilation (open windows or use fans)

## Instructions:

### 1. Preparation:

- Ensure the area is well-ventilated by opening windows or turning on a fan.
- Wear gloves to protect your hands, especially if you have sensitive skin.

### 2. Target the Mould:

- Identify the areas with visible mould or mildew (e.g., bathroom tiles, grout, silicone seals, or walls).
- The bleach within the spray will leave a mark on paintwork so spray just on the affected areas.

### 3. Apply the Spray:

- Shake the HG Mould Spray bottle gently.
- Spray the affected area from a distance of approximately 3-5 cm (1-2 inches).
- Be sure to cover all visible mould with an even layer of the product.

### 4. Allow Time to Work:

- Let the spray sit and work on the surface for 30 minutes to 1 hour. This gives it time to break down the mould effectively.

### 5. Rinse or Wipe:

- Use a damp cloth or sponge to wipe away the mould and any residue from the surface.
- Rinse thoroughly with clean water.

### 6. Repeat if Necessary:

- For very stubborn mould, you may need to reapply the spray and repeat the process.

### 7. Prevent Future Growth:

- To minimise future mould growth, keep the area dry and ventilated. For example:
- Keep the air in the location refreshed and circulating
- Wipe down tiles, windows and surfaces after showers or baths.

## Safety Notes:

Keep away from eyes. Do not use HG Mould Spray on metal, untreated wood, or painted surfaces, as it may cause damage. Avoid contact with fabrics, as the product may bleach them. Always test on a small, inconspicuous area first if you're unsure.

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